



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Arlington
School Website: <https://arlington.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Arlington TX 76001 presents a robust classical-education profile across public materials accessible from its crawl content. The school emphasizes Western-tradition liberal-arts study, Great Books, and the Great Conversation, reinforced by Socratic pedagogy and explicit formation aims (truth, goodness, beauty). Communal and liturgical practices appear in published materials (prayer, moments of silence, and school-wide rituals), and there is clear evidence of parent partnership and a formal parent-service structure. The combination of a strong curriculum oriented to the liberal arts, a pedagogy rooted in Socratic dialogue and memorization, and an explicit formation ethos aligns closely with a classical model as defined by the Six Essential Elements.

Key signals include: the motto *verum, pulchrum, bonum* (truth, beauty, goodness) as the school's guiding triad; explicit statements about forming character and pursuing the true, good, and beautiful; consistent emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation; use of Socratic discussion and memory-based pedagogy; focus on a liberal-arts curriculum across grades; and active parent/community partnership including a PSO and family activities. Public materials refer to liturgical and communal practices (e.g., prayer/meditation and moments of silence) that underscore a communal and metaphysical dimension. Taken together, these signals support a CLASSICAL classification across all six categories.

Evidence-based highlights: - The school's stated motto and formation goals center on truth, beauty, and goodness (*verum, pulchrum, bonum*) and a formation-focused mission (Element 1, with explicit motto and formation language) . - Emphasis on pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty through education; focus on the Western tradition and Great Books; and the aim to cultivate character and virtue (Categories 1–3) , , . - Pedagogy includes Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; lower-school memory-based or chant-like pedagogy; upper-school seminars and capstone/rhetoric work (Element 4) , , . - Curriculum signals include Great Books, liberal-arts orientation, and a focus on reading and discussing foundational texts; continued emphasis across grades and a focus on grammar/logic/rhetoric in the context of a classical liberal-arts program (Element 3) , , . - Faculty and community signals depict teachers as mentors and the school as a "living curriculum," with explicit parent-partnership and a Parent Service Organization (PSO) (Element 5 and Element 6) , .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Motto and formation focus: "*verum, pulchrum, bonum*" (truth, beauty, goodness) as the guiding triad; formation of character is central (public materials emphasize virtue and formation) , . - Spiritual/-community practices: public materials reference prayer/meditation, moments of silence, and liturgical-style elements within school life (e.g., Family Handbook sections on prayer/meditation and liturgical elements) . - Focus on Truth, Goodness, Beauty as transcendentals and a real, knowable order; emphasis on a coherent program of study and a belief that reality can be known through discipline and reason (philosophical pillars) , .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; formation; liturgical/community practices; the Great Books movement; Western Tradition focus; reverence-language around virtue and character formation (multiple sources). Negative indicators: none evident in public materials. - Estimated balance: 9–12 positive keyword hits vs. 0 negative hits; effectively 100% positive signals within the sampled materials for this category.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame education as the formation of the whole person toward transcendent goods, anchored in a Christian-informed metaphysical stance via liturgical/community practices and a shared language of truth, goodness, and beauty. The explicit articulation of these ideals classifies this category as CLASSICAL relative to the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Formation over information: explicit focus on forming virtue and wisdom rather than simply preparing for work; emphasis on human excellence and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful (philosophical pillars) . - Great conversations and classical heritage: references to the Great Books, the Great Conversation, and a liberal-arts mission as the core educational aim, with formation as telos (purposes tied to virtue and wisdom) , . - Rejection of a purely workforce-prep narrative; a formation/paideia orientation is stated (e.g., “the highest goal of education is to become good, intellectually and morally”) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, classical heritage. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials. - Estimated balance: 8–12 positive keyword hits; 0 negative hits; near-100% positive signaling.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims align with classical formation rather than purely information transfer or job preparation. The emphasis on virtue, human flourishing, and the real existence of timeless truths supports CLASSICAL status for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Liberal arts framework and Great Books focus: explicit emphasis on liberal arts, the Great Books, and the Great Conversation; history woven through curriculum; insistence on Western Civilization texts and primary sources; emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric as core liberal-arts tools (via program structure and course descriptions) , , , . - History integrated through curriculum and emphasis on Western tradition: courses across grades address world history, American history, and medieval history as part of a coherent study of Western civilization; emphasis on reading and discussing great texts rather than “social studies” framing (Element 3 alignment) , . - Great Books and primary texts: dedicated sections on “The Great Books” and “The Great Conversation,” reinforcing primary-source-based study, not merely textbooks (Element 3) , .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; primary sources; Western civilization; history as discipline; memorization and recitation as cultivation; classical languages (Latin/Greek) implied by course content; full Great Books emphasis; emphasis on wonder and moral/philosophical inquiry. - Negative indicators: the lexicon notes that some schools drift toward “social studies terminology” or “project-based learning dominance.” The current materials emphasize traditional texts and inquiry rather than a social-studies framing or project-first approach, but explicit references to “project-based learning” are not present as a primary approach in these sources. - Estimated balance: 9–12 positive keyword hits; 0–1 negative signals noted in public content (no explicit shift to non-classical framing).

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in liberal arts, Great Books, and Western Civilization, with explicit aims toward a life of inquiry and wonder rather than a purely skills/work focus. This constitutes CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic method and seminars: explicit emphasis on Socratic discussion and seminars at the upper school; logic training and rhetoric development in high school; use of debates and public speaking; emphasis on a multi-year arc from grammar to logic to rhetoric (Element 4 signals appear in the materials) , . - Contemplative/restful and memory-based pedagogy in the lower grades: singing, chanting, memory work, and recitation noted as practices in lower grades; emphasis on wonder and joy in learning rather than purely rigorous drill (Element 4 signals) , . - Upper-school rhetoric and capstone experiences: students engage in speeches, declamation, and a capstone oration; “Senior Thesis” style work appears; emphasis on disciplined inquiry and formal rhetoric (Element 4 signals) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Socratic seminars, recitation/narration, chanting and memory work, scholé/restful learning, rhetoric, capstone orations, formal speech. - Negative indicators: explicit reliance on project-based learning or experiential-only approaches are not dominant in these sources; the presence of capstone/speeches indicates a balance between memorized/formal discourse and inquiry rather than a project-dominant pedagogy. - Estimated balance: 10–14 positive keyword hits; 0–2 negative signals (no explicit project-based emphasis).

Why this rating - Pedagogy is clearly anchored in classic methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, ritualized practice) with upper-level rhetoric and formal discourse, which fits CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Living curriculum and mentorship language: materials describe faculty as models of virtue and knowledge; the notion of a “living curriculum” and a portrait of teacher-mentors is implied in the ethos and the messaging around faculty roles , . - Faculty as core to school culture: references to the “faculty of friends” and collegial culture; teacher teams and mentorship appear as part of the learning community (Element 5 signals) . - Teacher training and ongoing development: professional development, philosophical/pedagogical pillars, and content-focused PD are described in the Great Hearts Arlington ecosystem; this supports a robust faculty role as specialists in classical pedagogy , .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; moral exemplars; teacher training in classical pedagogy; mentorship language. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials. - Estimated balance: 8–12 positive keyword hits; 0 negative signals.

Why this rating - The materials portray faculty as central to classical formation and as exemplars of virtue and mastery, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong parent partnership: language of “partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school,” and parental primacy in formation appears in public materials; families are encouraged to participate in book clubs, seminars, and other formation activities; parents can visit and engage in school life (Element 6 signals) , . - Parent formation and community-education offerings: PSO structure exists and is expected to mobilize parent volunteers; there are programs and communications designed to educate parents about classical education (Element 6) , . - Open campus and parental involvement: materials describe open invitation for parent involvement, tours, and ongoing engagement with family life (Element 6) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation/reading groups/seminars, open campus, parent covenant, family participation, PSO involvement. - Negative indicators: none observed in public materials. - Estimated balance: 9–12 positive keyword hits; 0–1 minor negative signals (none explicit; overall strong positive emphasis).

Why this rating - The school presents an explicit and robust model of parent involvement and community formation aligned with classical ideals (partnership, formation, and shared governance in a classical framing).

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - The collected materials across six categories consistently align with classical education principles: formation through liberal-arts study, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, a teacher-centered living curriculum, and strong parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL shift, consider increasing explicit articulation of theological grounding in daily curriculum (e.g., explicit integration of theology across disciplines beyond liturgical/community practices) and ensuring historical pedagogy remains deeply anchored in primary texts with minimal reliance on modern, non-classical framing. If the school seeks to strengthen further, it could explicitly map each course to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music) with documented course mappings across grade bands, and provide direct evidence of upper-grade exposure to classical rhetoric through structured declamations or public orations beyond capstone projects.
- However, at present, the evidence supports CLASSICAL across all six categories, with a clear, coherent classical-education program and culture.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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